DECODE UPSC with Mounika

The Examiner’s Three Tricks

Cyclone Arnab · IDBI · RBI’s forex reserve · BRICS · COP17 · Ramsar · plus 7 Andhra Pradesh–Telangana topics

Week 44 · Coverage 26 Oct – 1 Nov 2026, with key carry-over from earlier in October · Videos released Sun 1 Nov 2026

Useful for: **UPSC CSE Prelims 2027** · **APPSC / TGPSC Group-1** · **RBI Grade B** · **AP/TS Group-2**

How to use these notes

- **Watch the videos first, then read these notes.** This week has two: the **Prelims Grid** (16 topics) and the **AP–TG Desk** (7 Telugu States topics).
- **Each topic has three parts:** why it is in the news, the static facts the examiner marks, and the Prelims trap.
- **Practise:** attempt the 25 MCQs in Part C *before* you check the answer key in Part D.
- **Revise:** the one-page sheet in Part E is your week on a page.
- **Currency:** facts are as of **1 Nov 2026**. Items marked *reported* were not yet confirmed on the official page, so check them before quoting.

The examiner’s three tricks this week. Every trap below is one of three moves.

1. **Swap the body or the ministry.** DIPAM placed in Commerce · GRAP “invoked by the CPCB” · the GII “by the WEF” · the Emissions Gap “by the IPCC” · GI “under Culture” · NSAP “under Social Justice”.
2. **Move the place or the date.** Yanam placed “in Andhra Pradesh” · the CDRI placed “in Gurugram” · Savings Day moved to “31 October” · the barrage put “on the Godavari main stem”.
3. **Stretch the set or the number.** 30×30 “combined” · Saudi Arabia added “to BRICS” · Chilika kept “on the Montreux Record” · Article 243D(6) read as “mandatory”.

Part A · Prelims Grid: 16 topics UPSC-Pre · Group-1

1. Cyclone Arnab GS-1 · GS-3 · APPSC

- **Why in news:** Very Severe Cyclonic Storm (VSCS) **Arnab** crossed the Andhra Pradesh–Yanam coast in the Godavari delta on **28 Oct 2026**, between Narsapur and Yanam (IMD position, as reported).
- **How a cyclone forms:** warm sea water (≥ 26.5–27 °C), enough **Coriolis force** (none at the Equator, so no cyclones within about 5°), weak vertical wind shear, and a pre-existing low.
- **How cyclones are named:**
  - **13 countries** on the WMO/ESCAP Panel give 13 names each, so the list has **169 names** (adopted 2020).
  - **RSMC New Delhi (IMD)** gives the next name once a storm reaches **62 km/h** (Cyclonic Storm).
  - A name is never repeated. “Arnab” came from **Bangladesh’s** list.
- **IMD scale (km/h):**

Class	CS	SCS	VSCS	ESCS	SuCS
Wind speed	62–88	89–117	118–166	167–221	≥ 222

- **Trap:** ❌ "Yanam is part of Andhra Pradesh." ✅ Yanam belongs to the **UT of Puducherry**, which has four parts: Puducherry, Karaikal, Mahe and Yanam.

2. IDBI Bank sale `GS-3 · RBI Grade B`

- **Why in news:** on **14 Oct**, the **CCEA** cleared the sale of **60.72%** of IDBI Bank (GoI 30.48% + LIC 30.24%) to a Fairfax company, for about **₹52,878 crore**. RBI approval is pending.
- **How a strategic sale works: DIPAM** (Ministry of **Finance**) runs it → the **CCEA** (chaired by the PM) approves it → the **RBI** checks that the buyer is "fit and proper" to control a bank.
- **History:** 1964 IDBI Act (as an RBI subsidiary) → 1976 transferred to GoI → 2004 IDBI Bank.
- **Trap:** ❌ "IDBI is a public sector bank." ✅ The RBI has classed it as a **private sector bank since January 2019**, after LIC took majority control.

3. RBI's Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve `GS-3 · RBI Grade B`

- **Why in news:** on **10 Oct**, the RBI asked banks to keep a **20% reserve**, in **cash with the RBI** and earning **no interest**, on specified rupee forex derivative contracts **above $2 mn**. Separately, the limit for dealing **without proving an underlying exposure** was cut from **$100 mn to $5 mn**.
- **FERA vs FEMA:**

	FERA 1973	FEMA 1999
Nature	**Criminal**	**Civil** (penalties, compounding)
In force	1974	**1 June 2000**
Enforced by	Enforcement Directorate	Enforcement Directorate

- **Trap:** ❌ "These rules come under FERA." ✅ **FEMA**. FERA was repealed, and forex violations are no longer criminal offences.

4. Delhi's air: GRAP Stage I `GS-3`

- **Why in news:** Delhi's AQI reached **244 (poor)** on **21 Oct**, and **GRAP Stage I** was invoked across the NCR.
- **AQI bands:** Good 0–50 · Satisfactory 51–100 · Moderate 101–200 · **Poor 201–300** · Very Poor 301–400 · Severe 401+.
- **GRAP stages:** I = poor · II = very poor · III = severe · IV = severe+ (above **450**).
- **Two bodies:** GRAP is invoked by the **CAQM**, a statutory body under a **2021 Act**. The **CPCB** publishes the AQI, which was launched in 2014 and tracks **8 pollutants**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The CPCB invokes GRAP." ✅ The **CAQM** invokes it; the CPCB only publishes the index.

5. Vigilance Awareness Week `GS-2 · GS-4`

- **Why in news:** the CVC is marking the week from **26 Oct to 1 Nov** (it contains Sardar Patel's birth anniversary on 31 Oct). The theme is **"Probity for Prosperity"**.
- **About the CVC:**
  - Set up in **1964** by executive resolution, on the **Santhanam Committee's** advice.
  - **Statutory** since the **CVC Act, 2003**.
  - Made up of the CVC plus up to 2 Vigilance Commissioners, each serving 4 years or until age 65.
  - Selected by the **PM, the Home Minister and the Leader of the Opposition**, and appointed by the **President**.
- **Look-alike set: Lokpal** (2013 Act) · **CBI** (executive, DSPE Act 1946) · **CAG** (the only **constitutional** one, Art 148).
- **Trap:** ❌ "The CVC is a constitutional body." ✅ It is **statutory** (2003 Act).

6. India joins SIOFA GS-2 · GS-3

- **Why in news:** in mid-October, India approved becoming a **full party** to the Southern Indian Ocean Fisheries Agreement. It had been a cooperating non-party since 2022.
- **Three ocean bodies:**

Body	Covers	Seat
SIOFA (signed 2006, in force 2012)	**Non-tuna** fish on the high seas	Réunion
IOTC (an FAO body; India is a member)	**Tuna**	Seychelles
CCAMLR	Antarctic marine life	Hobart

- **Trap:** ❌ "SIOFA manages tuna." ✅ Tuna is the job of the **IOTC**.

7. Global Hunger Index 2026 GS-2 · Social

- **Why in news:** India is ranked **100 of 122**, with a score of **24.1**, in the **"serious"** category. The Government disputes the method.
- **How it is weighted:** undernourishment **1/3** · child mortality **1/3** · child stunting **1/6** · child wasting **1/6**. A score of 20–35 counts as **serious**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The GHI is published by the FAO or the WFP." ✅ It comes from **aid organisations led by Welthungerhilfe**. The FAO and its partners publish a different report, the **SOFI**.

8. Poland joins the CDRI GS-2

- **Why in news:** Poland's Prime Minister visited India on **21–23 Oct**. The two sides aim to **double trade by 2030**, and Poland **announced** it will join the CDRI. India and Poland have been strategic partners since August 2024.
- **India-led alliances:**

Alliance	Launched	Seat
ISA	2015, COP21 Paris (with France)	**Gurugram**
CDRI	2019, UN Climate Action Summit, **New York**	**New Delhi**
Global Biofuels Alliance	2023, G20 New Delhi	—
International Big Cat Alliance	2023 (50 years of Project Tiger)	—

- **Trap:** ❌ "The CDRI sits in Gurugram." ✅ The **CDRI is in New Delhi**; the **ISA is in Gurugram**.

9. 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum GS-2

- **Why in news:** held at **Samvidhan Sadan, New Delhi**, on **26–27 Oct**, and chaired by the **Lok Sabha Speaker**. India holds the BRICS chair in 2026.
- **The 10 full members:** BRIC (2009) · South Africa (2010) · Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE (2024) · Indonesia (2025). The New Development Bank (NDB) is headquartered in **Shanghai**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "Saudi Arabia is a full member." ✅ It was invited but **has not confirmed**.

10. CBD COP17, Yerevan GS-3

- **Why in news:** COP17 is in **Yerevan, Armenia**, from **19 to 30 Oct**. It is the first global review of the **Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF)**.
- **The convention family:**
  - **CBD:** Rio, 1992 · secretariat in Montreal · the **USA is not a party** · India hosted **COP11 in Hyderabad (2012)**.
  - **Cartagena Protocol** (2000): biosafety.

  - **Nagoya Protocol** (2010): access and benefit-sharing.
  - **KMGBF** (2022): **23 targets**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "30×30 means 30% of land and sea combined." ✅ It means **30% of land AND 30% of sea, each, by 2030**.

11. UNEP Emissions Gap Report GS-3

- **Why in news:** the report, released **21 Oct**, projects about **2.8 °C** of warming under current policies, and about **2.6 °C** even if every pledge is met.
- **Who publishes what: UNEP:** Emissions Gap and Adaptation Gap · **IPCC:** Assessment Reports · **WMO:** State of the Global Climate · **UNFCCC:** NDC Synthesis Report.
- **India's targets:** emissions intensity **45% lower** than 2005 by 2030 · **50%** of power capacity from non-fossil sources by 2030 · **net zero by 2070**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The Emissions Gap Report is the IPCC's." ✅ It is **UNEP's**.

12. Loss and Damage Fund: first allocation GS-3 · GS-2

- **Why in news:** on **22 Oct**, the Fund's Board made its **first-ever allocation**: **$20 mn (provisional)** to **Nepal** for recovery from the August floods.
- **About the fund (FRLD):** agreed at **COP27 (2022)** and made operational at **COP28 (2023)**. It is hosted by the World Bank, and its Board sits in the Philippines.
- **The other climate funds: GCF** (Cancún 2010; based in **Songdo, South Korea**) · **GEF** (1991) · **Adaptation Fund** (Kyoto Protocol).
- **Trap:** ❌ "Loss and damage is paid from the Green Climate Fund." ✅ It has **its own fund, the FRLD**. The GCF pays for mitigation and adaptation.

13. Ramsar sites reach 103 GS-3 · Places

- **Why in news:** on **15 Oct**, India reached **103** Ramsar sites. The new ones are **Sukhna Wetland (Chandigarh)** and **Sauj Jheel (Mainpuri, UP)**.
- **Four Ramsar facts:**
  - The convention was signed at **Ramsar, Iran, on 2 Feb 1971**; India joined in **1982**.
  - India's first sites were **Chilika and Keoladeo** (1981).
  - India's **Montreux Record** (sites under threat): **Keoladeo** (1990) and **Loktak** (1993).
  - India's largest site is the **Sundarbans**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "Chilika is on the Montreux Record." ✅ It was **removed in 2002**.

14. A new GI tag (reported) GS-1 · GS-3

- **Why in news: Ambaji's Mohanthal** (a temple prasad from Gujarat) has **reportedly** received a GI tag. Confirm it in the GI Journal before quoting.
- **The GI law:**
  - GI of Goods (Registration and Protection) **Act 1999**, in force **2003**; it implements TRIPS Arts 22–24.
  - Registered by the **GI Registry, Chennai**, under the CGPDTM, DPIIT, **Ministry of Commerce**.
  - Valid for **10 years** and renewable any number of times.
  - India's first GI was **Darjeeling tea**.
- **Telugu States GIs:** Tirupati Laddu · Pochampally Ikat · Araku Valley coffee · Banganapalle mango.
- **Trap:** ❌ "A GI tag is a permanent, one-time grant" or "it is under the Culture Ministry." ✅ It lasts **10 years, renewable**, and sits under **Commerce**.

15. Global Innovation Index 2026 GS-3 · RBI Grade B

- **Why in news:** India is **38th of 139** economies, and **1st among lower-middle-income** economies. Switzerland, Sweden and the USA top the list.
- **Who publishes what: GII:** WIPO (Geneva) · **World Investment Report:** UNCTAD · **Global Gender Gap Report:** WEF · **Human Development Report:** UNDP.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The GII is published by the WEF." ✅ It is published by **WIPO**.

16. Three days to note GS-1

- **27 Oct, Infantry Day:** marks 1947, when troops of **1 Sikh** were air-landed at **Srinagar**.
- **30 Oct, World Savings Day (India):** the day began in Milan in 1924. Most countries mark it on 31 Oct; **India marks it on 30 Oct**.
- **31 Oct, Rashtriya Ekta Diwas:** marked since 2014 on **Sardar Patel's** birth anniversary. His **Statue of Unity** (182 m) stands at **Ekta Nagar, on the Narmada**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "India marks World Savings Day on 31 Oct." ✅ India marks it on **30 Oct**.

Part B · AP–TG Desk: 7 Telugu States topics APPSC · TGPSC Group-1

1. AP's BC quota in local bodies GS-2 · APPSC

- **Why in news:** on **1 Oct**, the **AP High Court** set aside the orders giving **34%** BC reservation in rural local bodies. On **9 Oct**, the **Supreme Court** dismissed the State's appeal. The AP Cabinet has since adopted its dedicated commission's report.
- **The triple test** (*Vikas Kishanrao Gawali*, 2021):
  1. a **dedicated commission** studies backwardness;
  2. the quota is fixed **body by body** on that data;
  3. total SC + ST + OBC reservation stays **≤ 50%**.
- **The judgment chain:** *Indra Sawhney* 1992 (50% ceiling) → *K. Krishna Murthy* 2010 → *Gawali* 2021.
- **Trap:** ❌ "Article 243D makes a BC quota in panchayats mandatory." ✅ **Art 243D(6)** (panchayats) and **243T(6)** (municipalities) are **enabling, not mandatory**.

2. Telangana HC: acting Chief Justice GS-2 · TGPSC

- **Why in news: Justice P. Sam Koshy** is the acting Chief Justice of the Telangana High Court, after the Chief Justice was elevated to the Supreme Court.
- **The High Court Articles: 214** a High Court for each State · **217** appointment of judges · **223** acting Chief Justice · **224** additional and acting judges · **224A** retired judges · **231** one High Court for two or more States.
- Telangana has had its **own High Court since 1 Jan 2019**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The CJI appoints the acting Chief Justice." ✅ The **President** does, under **Art 223**.

3. Who pays AP's pension? GS-2 · Telugu States Lens

- **Why in news:** under **NTR Bharosa**, the State pays an elderly pensioner **₹4,000 a month**. Of this, the Centre's share is only **₹200** (under IGNOAPS), about one-twentieth.
- **NSAP**, run by the **Ministry of Rural Development**, pays:
  - **IGNOAPS:** ₹200 a month at ages 60–79, ₹500 from age 80;
  - **IGNWPS** (widows): ₹300;
  - **IGNDPS** (disability): ₹300;
  - **NFBS** (family benefit): ₹20,000 once;
  - **Annapurna:** 10 kg of free grain a month.
- **Trap:** ❌ "NSAP is run by the Social Justice Ministry." ✅ It is run by **Rural Development**.
- **Group-1 Mains practice:** *Describe the State's social security pensions and the role of central assistance.*

4. Krishna and Godavari river boards GS-1 · GS-2

- **Why in news:** the **KRMB** (26 Oct) and **GRMB** (30 Oct) were scheduled to meet, with the **Polavaram backwater** on the GRMB agenda.
- **Boards vs tribunals:**

Body	Basis
KRMB, GRMB	AP Reorganisation Act 2014, **s.85**
Apex Council (Union Jal Shakti Minister + both CMs)	APRA 2014, s.84
Polavaram (a **national project**)	APRA 2014, s.90
Water tribunals	**Inter-State River Water Disputes Act 1956**, under **Art 262**
KWDT-I / KWDT-II / GWDT	Report 1973 / 2010 / 1980

- **Remember it as:** boards manage, tribunals decide.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The river boards are Art 262 tribunals." ✅ They are bodies created by **APRA 2014**.

5. Tummidihatti barrage `GS-1 · TGPSC`

- **Why in news:** on **26 Oct**, Telangana's CM held talks in Mumbai. Telangana wants a full reservoir level of **152 m**, against the **148 m** it says was agreed in 2016. The two States agreed to form a **joint committee of officials**.
- **The river:** the **Pranahita** = **Wardha + Wainganga**. It runs along the Telangana–Maharashtra border and joins the **Godavari at Kaleshwaram**.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The barrage is on the Godavari main stem." ✅ It is on the **Pranahita**, a tributary.

6. Who runs a disaster response? `GS-3 · APPSC`

- **Why in news:** Andhra Pradesh ran its response to Cyclone Arnab through its **State Disaster Management Authority**.
- **The Disaster Management Act, 2005:**
  - **NDMA** (s.3): chaired by the **Prime Minister**;
  - **SDMA** (s.14): chaired by the **Chief Minister**;
  - **DDMA** (s.25): chaired by the **Collector**;
  - **NDRF:** set up under **s.44**.
- **Warnings:** the IMD is the **RSMC New Delhi** for the north Indian Ocean.
- **Trap:** ❌ "The SDMA is chaired by the Governor." ✅ The **Chief Minister** chairs it.

7. Kolleru: a sanctuary's limits `GS-3 · APPSC`

- **Why in news:** Andhra Pradesh has asked the Supreme Court's **Central Empowered Committee** to exclude about **20,000 acres** from the Kolleru Wildlife Sanctuary (*as reported*).
- **The lakes, as a set:**

Lake	Type	State	Ramsar
Kolleru	**Freshwater**, between the Krishna and Godavari deltas	AP	2002
Chilika	Brackish lagoon	Odisha	1981
Pulicat	Brackish lagoon	AP–Tamil Nadu	(not covered here)
Sambhar	Saline	Rajasthan	1990
Loktak	Freshwater, with phumdis	Manipur	1990

- **Trap:** ❌ "Kolleru is a brackish lagoon like Chilika." ✅ Kolleru is **freshwater**.

Part C · Practise: 25 MCQs UPSC format

1. Consider the following statements:

1. A tropical cyclone in the north Indian Ocean is named only after it reaches cyclonic-storm strength.
2. Yanam is a part of the State of Andhra Pradesh.
3. A Very Severe Cyclonic Storm has sustained winds of 118–166 km/h.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

2. Consider the following statements:

1. IDBI Bank is classified by the RBI as a private sector bank.
2. Strategic disinvestment decisions are approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs.
3. DIPAM functions under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

3. Consider the following statements:

1. FEMA, 1999 replaced FERA, 1973, and made forex violations civil offences.
2. FEMA is enforced by the Enforcement Directorate.
3. The new Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve is held in cash with the RBI and earns no interest.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

4. Consider the following statements:

1. GRAP Stage I is invoked when the AQI is in the “poor” band (201–300).
2. The Central Pollution Control Board invokes GRAP.
3. India’s AQI measures only PM2.5 and PM10.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

5. Consider the following statements:

1. The CVC was set up in 1964 on the recommendation of the Santhanam Committee.
2. The CVC was given statutory status in 2003.
3. The Central Vigilance Commissioner is appointed by the President.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

6. Consider the following statements:

1. SIOFA manages tuna stocks in the Indian Ocean.
2. The Indian Ocean Tuna Commission is based in the Seychelles.
3. SIOFA applies to the high seas, beyond national jurisdiction.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

7. Consider the following statements:

1. The Global Hunger Index is published by the FAO.
2. Undernourishment carries one-third of the GHI weight.
3. India was placed in the “alarming” category in GHI 2026.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

8. Consider the following statements:

1. The International Solar Alliance has its secretariat in Gurugram.
2. The CDRI was launched at COP21 in Paris.
3. The Global Biofuels Alliance was launched during India’s G20 presidency.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

9. Consider the following statements:

1. Indonesia became a full member of BRICS in 2025.
2. Saudi Arabia is a full member of BRICS.
3. The New Development Bank is headquartered in Shanghai.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

10. Consider the following statements:

1. The 30×30 target protects 30% of land and sea taken together.
2. CBD COP17 is being held in Baku.
3. The United States is a party to the CBD.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

11. Consider the following statements:

1. The Emissions Gap Report is published by the IPCC.
2. India has announced a net-zero target of 2070.
3. Under current policies, warming is projected at about 1.5 °C.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

12. Consider the following statements:

1. The Loss and Damage Fund was agreed at COP27.
2. The Green Climate Fund is headquartered in Songdo, South Korea.
3. The Loss and Damage Fund’s first allocation went to Bangladesh.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

13. Consider the following statements:

1. Chilika Lake is on the Montreux Record.
2. The Ramsar Convention was signed in Iran in 1971.
3. India’s first Ramsar sites were the Sundarbans and Loktak.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

14. Consider the following statements:

1. A GI registration is valid for ten years and can be renewed.
2. The GI Registry is located in Chennai.
3. The GI Act is administered by the Ministry of Culture.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

15. Consider the following pairs (report : publisher):

1. Global Innovation Index : WIPO
2. World Investment Report : UNCTAD
3. Human Development Report : UNDP

How many of the above pairs are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

16. Consider the following statements:

1. India observes World Savings Day on 31 October.
2. Rashtriya Ekta Diwas marks Sardar Patel’s birth anniversary.
3. The Statue of Unity stands on the banks of the Godavari.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

17. Consider the following statements:

1. Article 243D(6) obliges States to reserve seats for Backward Classes in panchayats.
2. The triple test requires a dedicated commission to study backwardness.
3. Under the triple test, total reservation in local bodies may not exceed 50%.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

18. Consider the following statements:

1. The acting Chief Justice of a High Court is appointed by the President.
2. Article 231 allows one High Court for two or more States.
3. Article 224A deals with the appointment of the Chief Justice of India.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

19. Consider the following statements:

1. Under IGNOAPS, the Centre pays ₹200 a month to beneficiaries aged 60–79.
2. NSAP is administered by the Ministry of Rural Development.
3. Annapurna gives 10 kg of free food grain a month.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

20. Consider the following statements:

1. KRMB and GRMB were created under the AP Reorganisation Act, 2014.
2. River water tribunals are set up under the Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956.
3. Polavaram is a national project under the AP Reorganisation Act, 2014.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

21. Consider the following statements:

1. The Pranahita is formed by the confluence of the Wardha and the Wainganga.
2. The Pranahita is a tributary of the Krishna.
3. The Tummidihatti barrage is proposed on the main stem of the Godavari.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

22. Consider the following statements:

1. The NDMA is chaired by the Prime Minister.
2. The SDMA is chaired by the Governor.
3. The NDRF is constituted under the Disaster Management Act, 2005.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 only
(b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

23. Consider the following statements:

1. Kolleru is a brackish-water lagoon.
2. Kolleru lies between the Krishna and Godavari deltas.
3. Pulicat is a brackish lagoon on the AP–Tamil Nadu border.

How many of the above statements are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

24. (Warm-up) Consider the following places:

1. Yanam
2. Karaikal
3. Mahe

How many of the above are part of Andhra Pradesh?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

25. (Warm-up) Consider the following lakes:

1. Kolleru
2. Chilika
3. Pulicat

How many of the above are freshwater lakes?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

Part D · Answer key

Q	Ans	Why
1	b	1 and 3 are correct. Yanam belongs to Puducherry UT
2	b	1 and 2 are correct. DIPAM is in the Ministry of Finance
3	c	All three are correct
4	a	Only 1 is correct. The CAQM invokes GRAP, and the AQI tracks 8 pollutants
5	c	All three are correct
6	b	2 and 3 are correct. Tuna is the IOTC's job
7	a	Only 2 is correct. The GHI is Welthungerhilfe-led, and India is in the "serious" category
8	b	The CDRI was launched in New York in 2019
9	b	Saudi Arabia has not confirmed membership
10	d	None is correct. The targets are separate, the venue is Yerevan, and the USA is not a party
11	a	Only 2 is correct. UNEP publishes the report, and the projection is ≈ 2.8 °C
12	b	1 and 2 are correct. The first allocation went to Nepal
13	a	Only 2 is correct. Chilika left the record in 2002; the first sites were Chilika and Keoladeo
14	b	1 and 2 are correct. The GI law sits with Commerce
15	c	All three pairs are correct
16	a	Only 2 is correct. India marks it on 30 Oct, and the statue is on the Narmada
17	b	2 and 3 are correct. Art 243D(6) only enables a quota
18	b	Art 224A is about retired judges
19	c	All three are correct
20	c	All three are correct
21	a	Only 1 is correct. The Pranahita joins the Godavari, and the barrage is on the Pranahita
22	b	The SDMA is chaired by the Chief Minister
23	b	2 and 3 are correct. Kolleru is freshwater
24	d	None. All three belong to Puducherry UT
25	a	Only Kolleru. Chilika and Pulicat are brackish

Part E · One-page revision sheet

#	Topic	Write this down
1	Cyclone Arnab	VSCS 118–166 km/h · named at ≥ 62 km/h (169 names, 2020) · Yanam is in Puducherry UT
2	IDBI Bank	60.72% to Fairfax · DIPAM → CCEA → RBI · private sector bank since 2019
3	RBI FERR	20% cash reserve, no interest · FX derivatives > $2 mn · FEMA 1999 (civil)
4	GRAP	Stage I = poor (201–300) · the CAQM (2021 Act) invokes it · the CPCB publishes the AQI
5	CVC	Statutory (2003) · 1964 Santhanam · the CAG is the constitutional one (Art 148)
6	SIOFA	Non-tuna, high seas · Réunion · tuna = IOTC (Seychelles)
7	Hunger Index	India 100/122, 24.1, serious · weights 1/3, 1/3, 1/6, 1/6 · Welthungerhilfe-led
8	CDRI	2019 New York, New Delhi · ISA 2015 Paris, Gurugram · Poland to join
9	BRICS	10 members · Indonesia 2025 · Saudi Arabia not a member · NDB Shanghai
10	CBD COP17	Yerevan · KMGBF 2022: 23 targets, 30% land AND 30% sea · COP11 Hyderabad
11	Emissions Gap	UNEP · 2.8 °C under current policies · India net zero 2070
12	Loss & Damage	Nepal $20 mn first · COP27 → COP28 · not the GCF (Songdo)
13	Ramsar	103 sites · Montreux: Keoladeo, Loktak (Chilika out 2002)
14	GI tag	Act 1999 · Chennai · 10 years, renewable · first: Darjeeling tea
15	Innovation Index	WIPO · India 38/139 · 1st among lower-middle-income
16	Days	27 Infantry · 30 Savings (India) · 31 Ekta Diwas (Statue of Unity, 182 m)
D1	BC quota	AP HC 1 Oct, SC 9 Oct · Art 243D(6) enabling · triple test (Gawali 2021) · ≤ 50%
D2	Telangana HC	Acting CJ Justice P. Sam Koshy · appointed by the President, Art 223
D3	NTR Bharosa	₹4,000/month · Centre ₹200 (IGNOAPS) · NSAP is MoRD
D4	KRMB · GRMB	APRA 2014 boards (s.85) · tribunals: 1956 Act, Art 262
D5	Tummidihatti	Pranahita = Wardha + Wainganga · FRL 152 m sought vs 148 m (2016)
D6	DM Act 2005	NDMA PM (s.3) · SDMA CM (s.14) · DDMA Collector (s.25) · NDRF s.44
D7	Kolleru	Freshwater, between the deltas · Ramsar 2002 · Chilika and Pulicat brackish

Decode UPSC with Mounika · Week 44 · Sources: PIB, RBI, IMD, CAQM, CVC, UNEP, WIPO, CBD Secretariat, Ramsar Convention, GI Registry, MoRD (NSAP), AP Reorganisation Act 2014, DM Act 2005; as reported by AIR, Business Today, Telangana Today, The Federal, Moneylife, The Hans India, Free Press Journal, The South First, Onmanorama, IBEF, ThePrint, Armenpress, The Kathmandu Post, Climate Home News, Swarajya, LiveLaw, Bar & Bench, Deccan Chronicle, The News Minute. Maps and visuals: our own work.